

Pierce Connaughton

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EXPERIENCE

SITA

Letterkenny, County Donegal, Ireland

Associate Software Engineer

Jul 2024 - Present

- Collaborate with 3 developers and 1 tester in designing and contributing to the implementation of design of system architecture to complete the user stories given by the product owner
- Translated intricate technical and business requirements for developers, delineating 150+ precise user stories and reducing cycle time by 30%, demonstrating sustained efficiency gains and continued focus on optimizing delivery speed
- Developed and maintained RESTful APIs using Java, Kafka, Kubernetes, and Spring Boot while also implementing changes to improve reliability and scalability in order to help process 1,000+ messages per second and manage high volume data streams
- Deployed web application by leveraging Neo4j, Spring, AWS, and Angular to help customers find lost luggage and belongings
- Streamlined data retention workflow by automating stale-data identification and expiration, eliminating manual queries, reducing backend storage load, and laying the groundwork for future data-integration improvements
- Built refund adjudicator leveraging Java, Kafka, Kubernetes, Spring Boot, and MongoDB that tracks passenger arrival times against bag-delivery timestamps, determining proper compensation for delayed baggage and ensuring accurate refund decisions
- Drove QA process improvements by enhancing log visibility, reducing environment setup time from 40 to 10 minutes per user story, cutting bug-investigation costs by 80%, and eliminating ~30% of workflow waste

Graduate Software Engineer

Jun 2023 - Jun 2024

- Collaborated with different teams to deliver web application that streamlined user interactions and improved customer satisfaction
- Led end-of-sprint demonstrations such as live product walkthroughs or presentation decks to product owners and technical leads, communicating progress, blockers, and newly implemented functionality
- Drive strategic integration of AI-powered engineering solutions, leveraging GitHub Copilot and proprietary coding agents across the full SDLC from planning to code review, to significantly enhance overall development efficiency and process robustness
- Elevate AI-assisted development quality by optimizing prompt engineering techniques, establishing best practices and anti-patterns for coding agents, and deploying clarification workflows for ambiguous requirements, ensuring higher fidelity outputs

WBT Systems

Dublin, County Dublin, Ireland

Junior Application Support Engineer

Aug 2022 - Dec 2022

- Provided Tier 3 support for incoming customer support tickets by leveraging Jira and Freshdesk to handle incoming support tickets
- Utilized SQL Server, Java, Jaspersoft, and WBT Systems' own template language eWebscripting, solving 50+ tickets

EDUCATION

Atlantic Technological University

Sligo, Ireland

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Sep 2018 - May 2022

Cumulative GPA: 75.66

Awards: Academic Excellence Award recipient

PROJECTS

Personal Portfolio | React, TypeScript

- Built responsive personal portfolio website, highlighting professional experience, project work, and integrated contact channels

AI Tweet Generator | Python, Kivy, KivyMD, X API

- Implemented a Python/Kivy mobile application integrating the X API to generate context-aware tweets and run sentiment analysis to identify positive, neutral, or negative tone

SKILLS

Technical Skills:

Agile, Scrum, Angular, Apache Kafka, AWS, Azure, Azure DevOps, Bootstrap, C#, CI/CD, Docker, Dynamics 365, Firebase, Git, GitHub Copilot, Java, JavaScript, jQuery, Kubernetes, Microservices, MongoDB, Neo4j, .NET, Node.js, NoSQL, Prompt Engineering, Python, React, REST APIs, Spring, Spring Boot, SQL, TypeScript